

****Core of Existence****

Elfona's Perspective

Respect your elders. Prioritize the needs of your people over personal desires. These tenets had been carved into my soul since childhood, principles as unshakable as the mountains. Yet now, for the first time in centuries, doubt gnawed at the edges of my resolve. My All-Seeing Eye pulsed faintly, its visions clouded—where Lord Charlie sat, there was only a void, a swirling abyss that devoured light and logic alike.

I quickened my pace through the castle corridors, the weight of heresy tightening like a noose around my throat. The stone walls seemed to whisper accusations as I passed, their ancient runes flickering in disapproval. Then I saw it—a fireball, colossal and searing, hanging in the sky like a mockery of the celestial moon. Its molten glow bathed the empire in an apocalyptic hue, casting long, distorted shadows over the land.

My breath hitched. **He's gone mad.** The thought slithered through my mind, treacherous and unbidden. Even voicing it in a whisper could mean my head, yet the sight of that cataclysmic spell—launched carelessly into the heavens, as though the world were his plaything—threatened to unravel me.

Clutching the folds of my robe, I forced myself toward the observatory. The fireball's aftermath lingered, its residual heat warping the air like a mirage. **For funzies*,* the soldiers had joked, their laughter tinged with unease. But there was nothing amusing about this. Power without restraint was a blade poised at the throat of creation itself.

As I reached my private quarters, I paused, my hand trembling against the door. The void in my visions, the unchecked displays of dominance—it all pointed to a truth I dared not speak. Lord Charlie was no longer just a ruler. He was becoming a force of nature, unmoored from consequence.

Yet duty compelled me forward. If the All-Seeing Eye could not pierce his shadow, perhaps reason could. I would confront him, not as a subject to his sovereign, but as one guardian of balance to another. The risk was mortal, but so was silence.

Steeling myself, I turned from the window, the fireball's fading light etching resolve into my bones. The path ahead was fraught with peril, but if the core of existence was to endure, someone had to temper the storm—even if it meant standing against a god.

I couldn't let our nation see such unchecked displays of power as something to be accepted. We were the examples the people followed, the standard by which morality and restraint were measured. I had to put my Clairvoyance to good use. If I could find the source of his power, perhaps I could understand what was corrupting him from within. Lord Charlie had always taught us to ask questions, to seek understanding. Surely, he wouldn't mind me searching for answers.

I stepped into my personal quarters, a sanctuary within the ancient castle. The room was a paradox—a lush garden filled with vibrant flowers and the gentle hum of nature, yet existing in a dimensional plane separate from the physical world. If I locked the door, the room would become intangible, undisturbed, and untouchable. It was the perfect place for moments like this.

I sat on the ground, crossing my legs and focusing on my breathing. As an elf, I had perfect control over the surrounding mana but limited mastery over my own. Yet I channeled every ounce of my energy, feeling the tips of my ears grow warm as I opened my All-Seeing Eye.

My vision shifted. The floral field before me dissolved, replaced by a vision of Lord Charlie standing with Liza. I focused harder, my sight accelerating, plunging deeper into the essence of his being. My vision blurred, then sharpened, and I found myself staring into something incomprehensible.

The world turned red, a bloody haze that warped and twisted. Darkness enveloped me, and I saw a massive hand—its center a swirling mass of pure void, devoid of light, life, or meaning. I followed the hand to the arm, to the shoulder, and finally to the face.

It was Lord Charlie.

But not the one I knew. This version of him was infinitely larger, his presence stretching beyond the boundaries of reality itself. His voice boomed, shaking the fabric of existence. “I AM #*\$&*#,” he declared, the words incomprehensible, their meaning lost in the chaos of his power.

My concentration shattered. I was thrown back into my body, gasping for air as a searing headache tore through my skull. The pain was unlike anything I had ever experienced, a visceral reminder of the impossibility of what I had just witnessed.

It was impossible. And yet, it was true.

The source of Lord Charlie’s power was not external. It was him. He had become a concept, a fundamental force of the omniverse—an *Archangel*.

“An Archangel,” I whispered, the words trembling on my lips.

A sharp knock on my door snapped me back to reality. I froze, my heart pounding in my chest. The headache still throbbed, but I forced myself to stand, smoothing my robes and composing my expression.

“Enter,” I called, my voice steady despite the storm raging within me.

The door creaked open, and a servant stepped inside, bowing deeply. “Lady Elfona, Lord Charlie requests your presence in the grand hall.”

I nodded, my mind racing. The path ahead was clear, though fraught with danger. If Lord Charlie had truly ascended to such a state, then the balance of the omniverse itself was at stake.

And I would be the one to restore it. I would be the one to bring back our lord.